Task 3 – Conversation

- The conversation is in two parts, each covering a separate theme.
- The whole conversation is recommended to last between **3½ and 4½ minutes** for **Foundation tier** and between **5 and 6 minutes** for **Higher Tier.**
- An equal amount of time must be allocated to each of the two themes.
- It is essential to keep strictly to the timings and avoid any imbalance between the two conversations or any shortfall or excess in timings.

Task 3 – Conversation

- Throughout the conversation (Part 1 and 2), in order to facilitate a genuine and spontaneous interaction, the nature of questions should enable candidates to:
  - answer questions freely, in turn, allowing them to produce extended sequences of speech
  - develop conversations and discussions
  - give and justify own thoughts and opinions
  - refer to past, present and future events.

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 1)

For Part 1, candidates will select and prepare one topic from one of the **themes** 1 to 5 in advance.

- To enable them to make a confident start, Teacher/Examiner (T/E) must allow the candidate to state their chosen topic and to talk about this for up to one minute without interruptions.
- The conversation must continue on the chosen topic and may extend to other topics within the **same theme** if necessary to ensure that candidates use the recommended time for this task most effectively.

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 1)

T/Es should ensure that candidates are not allowed to go on beyond one minute. If they do, they should be interrupted with their first question.

If the candidates are allowed to continue with the monologue (presentation), it will mean a minimum of 6 marks could be lost for interaction and spontaneity!

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 1)

Some Comments from Examiner's Reports - Conversation

- Some centres exceeded one minute time limit with the monologue taking between 3-4 minutes.
- Some T/Es also failed to ask questions beyond the candidate's presentation, and this meant they were asking questions that candidates had mentioned within their own monologue/presentation.
- On numerous occasions, some T/Es asked questions other than the Theme which was being discussed.

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 1)

- Some T/Es are still relying on a list of prepared questions, and in one extreme case, almost all the candidates had been directed to prepare the same topic for Conversation 1, even to the extent of providing identical introductions for the 1st minute.
- Some T/Es read out the same questions to each of the candidates so that the examination became a question and answer session instead of a spontaneous conversation.
- Some T/Es had clearly not been listening carefully to what the candidates were saying and confused them by asking questions, the answers to which had already been covered in the initial presentation.

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 2)

- Part 2 must cover a different theme to Part 1. A different theme will be allocated by Pearson using the sequencing grid for T/Es to select one.
- For each candidate, the T/Es have a choice of two themes on the sequencing grid. The T/Es must select one topic. Candidates are **not allowed to select** the theme in this part.
- This part of the conversation task may focus on one or more topics from the same selected **theme** if necessary to ensure that candidates use the recommended time for this task most effectively.

Task 3 – Conversation (Part 2)

Some Comments from Examiner's Reports - Conversation Part 2

- For the second part of the conversation, some T/Es failed to follow the sequencing grid. This meant they asked the candidates questions from the wrong **theme**.
- Some T/Es did not ask questions in standard Gujarati and it seemed that some candidates were more confident than the T/Es themselves.
- Some candidates were disadvantaged because the T/Es' failed to ask any questions that required the use of a tense other than the present.